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WHAT THE RSS SAYS

Issues That Matter the Most to the Sangh

There is a big difference in the public approaches taken by the BJP and the RSS. While individuals in both entities arguably subscribe to a common world view, the weightage that they give to various issues in their outward-facing discourse varies greatly. The RSS speaks much more about Hinduism than anything else, for instance. It also speaks about 'Hindu' issues far more than the BJP does.

We put all articles published by the RSS fortnightly magazine *Organiser* (230 issues in the May 2015–December 2019 period); all Facebook posts by the RSS, the BJP, Narendra Modi, Amit Shah, the Congress and Rahul Gandhi (January 2016–December 2019: 4,76,827 posts); and all the annual Vijayadashami speeches by the RSS sarsanghchalak over a three-year period (2016–2019) through our Narad Index[1] to get a broader sense of how the RSS communicates, and how this compares with the BJP, Narendra Modi and the Congress. The Narad Index shows that on all platforms, online and offline, RSS-speak on issues around Hindus or Hindu-related topics (like the Ram Temple in Ayodhya) outscored every other topic by a wide margin. This is followed by education, an issue that the Sangh focuses its energies on in its outreach. The only exception to this pattern is *Organiser*, where education came in second to Pakistan and Kashmir in 2019 (see Figure 13.1).